



Smartphones

For the sake of offering more options to the consumers, we've kept Android smartphones in a separate category, and the rest of the smartphones in this category, largely because of the sheer number of Android phones we've reviewed this year. And boy, have we seen some competition this year!

However, the competition wasn't just offered by Apple's iOS. At the time of writing this, Microsoft's Windows Phone 7.5 (Mango) based smartphones were trickling into the test centre, and we must say, we're impressed by what we see. We believe this will be the hottest smartphone OS next year, once we see enough handsets in the market. Earlier in the year, Symbian managed to get up for one more fight, with the Anna update really helping the truly terrible Symbian 3 get better and become more usable. Not to forget that Research in Motion (RIM) released two OS versions for the BlackBerry smartphones this year – the OS6 and the OS7. Just shows the amount of work being put into making the OS come on the same track as iOS and Android, as far as the user experience is concerned. And did we forget Bada? No we didn't! Samsung has launched the Wave 3 in India, and we'll offer a detailed review of how Bada 2.0 performs, soon.

Zero1 Winner

BlackBerry Bold Touch 9900

This is the sleekest BlackBerry smartphone we've seen till date, and brings the dual world goodness of a touchscreen plus a physical QWERTY keypad. Speaking of which, this keypad always makes us cry out with joy, for this is the very best we've seen in any smartphone till date, let alone a BlackBerry itself. The phone comes with the latest OS7, and having used the OS6 quite a lot, we can say that RIM is going in the right direction with the updates – superb performance, the Liquid Graphics, HD video recording and a very good touchscreen.

Detailed review:

<http://goo.gl/eACg7>



Samsung Omnia W

Price: ₹19,990



Nokia E6

Price: ₹16,160



Worthy Mentions

Samsung Omnia W

This is the first phone that we reviewed with Windows Phone 7 post the Mango update (that bumped it to 7.5), and if this is how impressed we are, you can safely say WP is off to a flying start! The UI is absolutely smooth, and the background app load tends to make absolutely no difference. This comes as no surprise considering that the device runs on a 1.4GHz processor and 512 MB of RAM. The Mango update vastly increases the visual appeal of the OS as well as improves the functionality. The live tiles with their simple animations look especially slick. The device is also home to a gorgeous 3.7" AMOLED display, the only issue with it being the extremely cramped keyboard in portrait mode. But the performance, that is what makes us cry with tears of joy. This is what Android was supposed to be.

Detailed review: <http://goo.gl/fUiLm>

Nokia E6

This is the logical successor to the hugely successful Nokia E72, and this one builds on that brilliance. The new Symbian Anna OS is able to handle the fun bits as well as the BlackBerry rivalling usage scenarios. The device performs well, but it is let down by the choice of processor and RAM. A 680MHz and 256 MB RAM just doesn't cut it anymore. The build quality of the device is very nice and it fits nicely in the hand as well. It's a heavy phone though. The battery life was surprisingly good, lasting almost two full days on a single charge. The build quality, slim form factor, a touch-screen that works, the very comfortable QWERTY keypad and the battery life is what really impressed us on this device. Placed bang in the middle of the BlackBerry Curve 3G and the Touch 9900, Nokia has its target clearly in sight.

Detailed review: <http://goo.gl/HaFZB>

BlackBerry Bold Touch 9900

Price: ₹33,000

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